

AURIC ARTISAN · USER DOCUMENTATION

# Search and the Search Console

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What the Auric Artisan search page and the Search Console are, who they are for, and how to run your first search.

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# Search and the Search Console

What the Auric Artisan search page and the Search Console are, who they are for, and how to run your first search.

The search page at <https://auricartisan.com/search/> finds tools, Learn articles, documentation, blog posts, changelog entries, portfolios and every other page on Auric Artisan. The search runs in your browser: the page downloads a small index of the site once, and everything you type is matched on your device. Results appear as you type, sorted by relevance, and you can narrow them to one section, sort them, and use a few simple operators such as `"a phrase"`, `-word` and `type:learn`.

Because this is a colour site, the search also answers colour questions directly. Type a hex code such as `#d3af37` and an answer card shows the colour with its contrast against black and white. Type two hex codes and it judges them as a text and background pair against WCAG 2.1. Type the name of a common tool, such as `contrast`, and a card takes you straight to it.

The globe button switches to a second index: Auric Artisan's own crawl of the web, an independent index much smaller than the big search engines. Site owners can put their own site into that index, and see how it is found, with the free **Search Console** at <https://auricartisan.com/search/console/>.

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## Who it is for

- Anyone looking for a tool, article or guide on Auric Artisan.
- Designers and developers who want a quick colour or contrast answer without opening a tool.
- People searching the wider web for colour and design resources.
- Site owners who want their site in Auric Artisan's web index and want to know why a page is or is not included.

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## Where to find it

- The search page: <https://auricartisan.com/search/> (also in the site menu under **Search**).
- From anywhere on the site: open Spotlight with `Ctrl + K`, type, and choose **View all results for** your query.
- Select text on any page, right-click and choose **Search this site**.
- The Search Console: <https://auricartisan.com/search/console/> (in the site menu under **Search**, and linked from the bottom of the search page as **Put your site in it**).
- Searching needs no account. The Search Console needs an Auric Artisan account.

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## Quick start

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/search/>.
2. Type at least two characters, for example `oklch gradient`. Results appear as you type.

3. Select a section tab, such as **Learn**, to see only that kind of page.
  4. Hover a result, or press the down arrow, to see why it ranked where it did.
  5. Press **Enter** or select a result to open it.
  6. Type a hex code such as **#1d2a3e** to see the colour and its contrast.
  7. To search the web instead, select the globe button beside the field and press **Enter**.
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## What you can do

- Search every page on the site, on your device, with typo correction and related-word matching.
  - Narrow results by section: **All**, **Tools**, **Learn**, **Docs**, **Blog**, **Portfolios** or **Pages**.
  - Sort by **Relevance**, **Newest** or **A-Z**.
  - Use phrases, exclusions and field filters such as **tag:** and **title:**.
  - Get instant colour, contrast-pair and tool answers.
  - See the score and matched fields behind every result.
  - Search Auric Artisan's own web index, with suggestions, spelling correction and paging.
  - In the Search Console, prove you own a site, request crawls, and see coverage, searches, clicks and positions for it.
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## In this folder

- **docs/** — task guides and reference.
- **others/** — glossary, shortcuts, limits, related pages and privacy.

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# Search documentation

Task guides, reference, troubleshooting and FAQ for the search page and the Search Console.

## Searching

| File                                      | What it covers                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">getting-started.md</a>        | A tour of the search page and a first search.                                    |
| <a href="#">search-this-site.md</a>       | Typing, suggestions, results, section tabs, sorting, paging and recent searches. |
| <a href="#">query-syntax.md</a>           | Phrases, exclusions and field filters, for the site and for the web.             |
| <a href="#">instant-answers.md</a>        | The colour, contrast-pair and tool cards.                                        |
| <a href="#">understand-the-ranking.md</a> | Why a result ranks where it does, and the score display.                         |
| <a href="#">search-the-web.md</a>         | The globe: searching Auric Artisan's own web index.                              |

## The Search Console

| File                                 | What it covers                                                              |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">search-console.md</a>    | Signing in, adding a site and proving you own it.                           |
| <a href="#">console-reports.md</a>   | Overview, Performance, Coverage, Pages, inspection and Links.               |
| <a href="#">request-a-crawl.md</a>   | Submitting pages and sitemaps, the crawl queue, and what the crawler obeys. |
| <a href="#">manage-your-sites.md</a> | The list of sites on your account, and removing one.                        |

## Reference and help

| File                               | What it covers                                    |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">reference.md</a>       | Every control, operator, status line and message. |
| <a href="#">troubleshooting.md</a> | Symptoms, causes and fixes.                       |
| <a href="#">faq.md</a>             | Short answers.                                    |

Back to the [Search overview](#).

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# Getting started with search

A tour of the Auric Artisan search page and a first search, step by step.

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## Before you start

You need nothing but a browser. Searching the site needs no account and no sign-in. The first time you open the page it prepares its index; the status line then reads **Index ready** with the number of items indexed.

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## A tour of the page

Before you type, the page shows a start screen:

- **The search field** at the top, with the placeholder **Search Auric Artisan**. A clear button appears once you type, and the globe button beside it switches to web search.
  - **A privacy line: Indexed on this device — nothing you type leaves the browser**. Your recent searches sit on the same line, with **Clear**.
  - **Three example cards** that run real queries when you select them:
    - **Paste a hex** — a colour with its contrast against black and white.
    - **Give it two** — a pair of colours judged for contrast.
    - **Narrow by section** — the query `type:learn contrast`, with how many pages it matches.
  - **A ribbon of sections** with how many pages each holds (for example Learn, Documentation, Tools), and the total number of **pages in the index**. Each section links to its own page.
  - **More ways to ask** — buttons for the operators `type:learn`, `"a phrase"`, `-word` and `tag:ok1ch`. Select one to put it in the field.
  - **A line about the globe**: it searches a second index, Auric Artisan's own crawl of the web, with a link to **Put your site in it**.
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## Your first search

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/search/>.
  2. Type `contrast`. After the second character, results start to appear.
  3. Because `contrast` is also the name of a tool, a **Tool** card leads the page with **Open the tool**. The results list follows.
  4. Add a word: `contrast charts`. The tool card goes away, because a tool card appears only when the whole query names the tool.
  5. Look at the line under the field. It shows how your query was read: each word as a chip, and related words, shown dashed, that were matched at reduced weight.
  6. Select the **Learn** tab to see only Learn articles. The number on each tab is how many results it holds.
  7. Press the down arrow to highlight the first result. A panel shows why it ranks there.
  8. Press `Enter` to open it.
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## Try a colour

1. Clear the field with the clear button or `Escape`.

2. Type `#777777 #ffffff`.
3. A **Contrast pair** card shows the ratio **4.48:1** and a table of AA and AAA results. Grey `#777777` on white just misses AA for body text, although it passes for large text.
4. Select **Swap them** to put the background first, or **Open the checker** to continue in the Contrast Checker.

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## Next steps

- [Search this site](#) — everything about the results list.
- [Query syntax](#) — the operators.
- [Instant answers](#) — the answer cards.
- [Search the web](#) — the globe.

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# Read the console reports

What the Overview, Performance, Coverage, Pages and Links sections of the Auric Artisan Search Console show, and how to inspect a single address.

These sections show data for the site chosen in the console header, once it is verified. Dated figures follow the period chosen at the top: **7d**, **28d** or **90d**. Each figure is compared with the same length of time just before it.

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## What counts as an impression and a click

- An **impression** is counted when a page from your site appears in a result on Auric Artisan's web search.
- A **click** is counted when a searcher opens that result.
- **Position** is where the result appeared in the list; lower is better.

Figures start counting the first time your site appears in a result.

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## Overview

The console opens on the Overview. It leads with what you can fix.

- **Four cards: Indexed pages**, with the share of known addresses; **Impressions** ("times you appeared"); **Clicks** ("times someone came"); **Average position** ("lower is better"). Each has a small trend line and the change against the previous period. In your first period the card says **first period** instead.
- **In the index** and **Not in the index**: the two counts, a bar that splits them, and how many of the addresses outside the index are yours to fix. The line below gives the total number of addresses the crawler has met on the site.
- **Why pages are not indexed**: every reason the crawler recorded, most common first. Reasons you can act on are listed first, marked **Yours**, each with its fix and a **Show them** button that opens **Pages** filtered

to those addresses. The rest follow under **Nothing to do about these**. **Open coverage** goes to the full Coverage section.

- **Crawl log**: what the crawler did, newest first. Similar outcomes from the same pass are grouped, for example **12 pages — Indexed**. Select a group to see its addresses, grouped by folder.

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## Performance

**Performance** lists every search that put your site in front of somebody.

- **Four figures** at the top: **Impressions**, **Clicks**, **Click-through** (clicks as a share of impressions) and **Average position**, each with the change against the previous period.
- **A chart** of impressions and clicks per day, with the peak of each. When there are only a few days with any impressions, the chart shows those days as columns instead, and a note says how many quiet days came before.
- **Choose how to group the table**: **By search**, **By page**, **By day**, **By country** or **By device**.
- **The table**: the search, page, day, country or device; **Impressions**, with a bar; **Clicks**; **CTR**; and **Position**. A dash means there were no clicks to calculate from.
- **By name or by topic**: grouped by search, a bar splits impressions between people who **were already looking for you by name** and people who **found you for something they wanted**. A search counts as "by name" when it contains your domain's name.

If nothing has been recorded yet, the page says **No impressions recorded yet. They start counting the first time this site appears in a result**.

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## Coverage

**Coverage** covers every address the crawler knows about on your site and, for those not indexed, why not.

At the top, three totals add up to every address outside the index:

| Total         | Meaning                                                   |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| On its way    | Fetches and keeps. Searchable after the next index build. |
| Needs you     | Only you can change these.                                |
| Nothing to do | Real, counted, and working as intended.                   |

Below them:

- A heading such as **3 pages need you**, or **Nothing needs you**.
- One row per reason you can act on, with what it means and **To fix**:. Select the page count on a row to open **Pages** filtered to those addresses.
- A folded list of the reasons with nothing to do, for example **40 with nothing to do about them**. Open it to read each one.

- **Crawl activity, 28 days:** a bar for each day, the total fetched, the peak day, and a chip for each HTTP status code the site answered with, with a count.
- **Sitemaps:** the sitemaps the crawler has read, and how many addresses were queued from them.

Every reason is listed, with its meaning and fix, under **Coverage reasons** in the [Reference](#).

## Pages

**Pages** lists every address on the site that the crawler has an opinion about.

- **Find a path** filters the list as you type. Try a folder such as `/blog/`, a word, or `.xml`.
- The chips **Everything**, **Indexed**, **Waiting**, **Excluded** and **Errored** filter by state, each with its count. **Waiting** covers addresses discovered or crawled but not yet in the index.
- **By folder** groups addresses by the folder they sit in, largest first. Each folder shows a bar of its states, its count and how many are **to fix**. Select a folder to open it. **Flat list** shows every address in one list.
- Each address shows its state, when it was last crawled, and its canonical address when that differs. Select the address to open it in a new tab.
- On a large site, a note says the list shows the most recently crawled addresses only.

## Inspect an address

Select **Inspect** on any row. A panel opens over the list:

- **A verdict** in words: the state, what it means, and **To fix:** or **Note:**.
- **Last crawl:** the HTTP **Status**, **Canonical**, **First seen**, **Last indexed**, the **Indexed title**, the page's **Static rank** out of 255, and, if it is queued, where it came from, its priority, attempts and any **Last error**.
- **Live now:** select **Fetch the page now** to fetch the page as it is at this moment. The panel shows the **Outcome** (status and time), any redirect, the canonical address, the robots meta tag and X-Robots-Tag header, **Still noindex** if the live page still asks not to be indexed, and **Title has changed** if the title differs from the indexed one.
- **Searches it appears for:** each search with impressions and position, or **No impressions for this page yet**.

At the bottom, **Ask for a crawl** queues the address; the panel says **Queued. Crawled within a day. Test live** fetches the live page again. Close the panel with the close button, by selecting outside it, or with `Escape`.

## Links

**Links** is meant to show who links to you and how the crawler walks your site: **Sites linking to you**, **Your most-linked pages**, **Pages nothing links to** and **Links that go nowhere**. These are **Not collected yet**, so the section stays empty rather than showing numbers nobody measured.

What it shows today is the site's rank, out of 255. Rank is worked out from links between sites. It is how much weight a page on your site carries when the search is choosing between two equally good matches.

# Instant answers

The colour, contrast-pair and tool cards that lead the Auric Artisan search results, what each value means and how to use them.

For some queries the search page answers the question itself, in a card above the results. There are three kinds. Answer cards appear in site search only, not in web search.

## The colour card

Type one hex code, for example `#d3af37`. Hex codes work with or without `#`, in three-digit or six-digit form.

The card is headed **Colour** and **read from your query · sRGB**. It shows:

- A large swatch of the colour, labelled with its OKLCH value.
- **On black** — the colour as text on black, with the contrast ratio and a grade.
- **On white** — the same on white.
- **Hex, RGB** and **OKLCH** values.

Two buttons follow:

- **Check it against a background** opens the Contrast Checker with this colour as the text colour.
- **Palettes with it** opens the Palette Library. The library opens at its usual view; to find palettes that contain the colour, type the hex code into the library's search field.

## Example

`#d3af37` gives:

| Value    | Result                  |
|----------|-------------------------|
| Hex      | #D3AF37                 |
| RGB      | rgb(211 175 55)         |
| OKLCH    | oklch(76.6% 0.138 91.6) |
| On black | 9.96:1, AAA             |
| On white | 2.11:1, FAILS           |

## Grades

The grade is for body text at that ratio, following WCAG 2.1:

| Grade | Ratio       |
|-------|-------------|
| AAA   | 7:1 or more |

| Grade    | Ratio                                   |
|----------|-----------------------------------------|
| AA       | 4.5:1 or more                           |
| AA LARGE | 3:1 or more; enough for large text only |
| FAILS    | Below 3:1                               |

## The contrast-pair card

Type two hex codes separated by a space, text colour first, then background: `#d3af37 #0d0d0d`. If you type more than two, the first two are used.

The card is headed **Contrast pair** and **WCAG 2.1 · relative luminance**. It shows:

- A sample sentence in the text colour on the background, at the 16 px body size the ratio is judged at, and the same pair reversed. Reversing a pair does not change its ratio.
- The contrast ratio, for example **9.22:1**, and a sentence saying what it means.
- A table of results, described below.
- **ΔL** — the difference in OKLCH lightness between the two colours, in percentage points. It is negative when the text is darker than the background.
- **Foreground** and **Background** rows, each with a swatch, the hex code and the OKLCH value.

The table has a row for each WCAG level and a column for body and large text. Each cell shows the threshold and is marked ✓ when the pair reaches it and ✗ when it does not:

| Level | Body | Large |
|-------|------|-------|
| AA    | 4.5  | 3.0   |
| AAA   | 7.0  | 4.5   |

Buttons:

- **Open the checker** opens the Contrast Checker with both colours.
- **Swap them** runs the search again with the colours the other way round.

## The sentences

| Ratio     | Sentence                                                                 |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7 or more | Clears every WCAG threshold, including AAA for body text at 7:1.         |
| 4.5 to 7  | Passes AA at any size and AAA for large text, but not AAA for body copy. |
| 3 to 4.5  | Large text only — body copy at this ratio does not reach AA.             |
| Below 3   | Below every WCAG threshold, at every text size.                          |

The results use the exact ratio, not the rounded one. For example, `#777777 #ffffff` shows **4.48:1** and fails AA for body text, even though it looks close to 4.5.

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## The tool card

When the whole query is the name of one of these tools, a **Tool** card marked **ready to use** leads the page, with a description and **Open the tool**:

| Query                                                  | Tool             |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| <code>contrast</code> or <code>contrast checker</code> | Contrast Checker |
| <code>palette</code>                                   | Palette Library  |
| <code>gradient</code>                                  | Gradient Library |
| <code>image picker</code>                              | Image Picker     |
| <code>analyzer</code>                                  | URL Analyzer     |

The card appears only for the exact query. `contrast in charts`, or any query with a filter, phrase or exclusion, shows ordinary results instead.

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## Accuracy

The ratios use the WCAG 2.1 relative luminance formula on sRGB values. They agree with the standard reference values: white on black is 21:1, and `#767676` on white is 4.54:1. See [Limits and accuracy](#).

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## Manage your sites

How to see every site on your Search Console account, switch between them, read how the crawler treats a site, and remove one.

**Your sites** in the Search Console's side rail lists every site on your account. It stays available even while a site is waiting to be verified, because it is where you add, prove and remove sites.

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## The list

The heading says how many sites the account has, for example **2 sites on this account. Removing one takes it off this console, not out of the index.**

Each row shows:

- The site's name and its status, such as verified or pending. The site the console is showing is marked **open**.

- For a verified site: how many pages are indexed, how many are excluded, and when it was last crawled, for example **120 indexed · 8 excluded · crawled 3 hours ago**.
- For an unverified site: **not proved yet — nothing is crawled until it is**.
- **Open**, to make it the site the console shows.
- **Remove**, to take it off your console.

You can also switch sites from the switcher in the console header, which appears when the account has more than one site.

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## How the crawler treats the open site

Below the list, a card named after the open site shows:

- The ownership line, for example **Ownership proven by file on the site, 2026-09-20**.
- **Last crawl** — when, and the HTTP status the site answered with.
- **Pace** — how long the crawler waits between requests to the site.
- **robots.txt** — **Found**, with when it was read, or **None**.
- **Could not be fetched** — how many addresses failed, with **See which, and why**, which opens Coverage. This appears only when there are failures.
- **The crawler is being turned away**. — shown when the crawler cannot get in at all, with the reason.

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## Remove a site

1. Select **Remove** on the site's row.
2. A dialog asks **Remove this property?** and explains what happens:
  - Its pages stay in the index. They were crawled from the open web, they keep being crawled, and searching still finds them.
  - You stop seeing them in the console.
  - Your search history for the site is deleted: impressions, clicks and positions. It does not come back.
  - You can add the site again later, but you must prove you own it again, and the history starts from then.
3. Select **Remove from my console** to go ahead, or **Keep it** to cancel. **Escape** or selecting outside the dialog also cancels.

The page then says the site **is no longer in your console. Its pages are still in the index**.

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## Keep pages out of the index

Removing a site from the console does not remove its pages from the index. To keep pages out, tell the crawler on the site itself: disallow them in robots.txt, or add a noindex robots meta tag or **X-Robots-Tag** header. See [Request a crawl](#).

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# Query syntax

The operators the Auric Artisan search page understands — phrases, exclusions and field filters — for site search and for web search.

Plain words are enough for most searches. The operators below narrow a search when you need to. The line under the search field shows how your query was read, with a chip for each filter, phrase, word and exclusion, so you can check that an operator was understood.

## Site search operators

| Operator                                        | Example                           | What it does                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Words                                           | <code>oklch gradient</code>       | Finds pages that contain the words; pages with more of them, and with the words close together, rank higher. |
| <code>"..."</code>                              | <code>"colour blindness"</code>   | Only pages where the words appear together, in that order.                                                   |
| <code>-word</code>                              | <code>palette -tailwind</code>    | Leaves out pages that contain the word. The word must be at least two characters.                            |
| <code>type:</code>                              | <code>type:learn contrast</code>  | Only one kind of page. See the list below.                                                                   |
| <code>tag:</code>                               | <code>tag:oklch</code>            | Only pages with a tag containing the value.                                                                  |
| <code>title:</code>                             | <code>title:gamut</code>          | Only pages whose title contains the value.                                                                   |
| <code>desc:</code> or <code>description:</code> | <code>desc:printing</code>        | Only pages whose description or text contains the value.                                                     |
| <code>path:</code>                              | <code>path:/library/learn/</code> | Only pages whose address contains the value.                                                                 |
| <code>category:</code>                          | <code>category:legal</code>       | Only pages whose category contains the value. Categories mostly match the <code>type:</code> values below.   |
| A hex code                                      | <code>#d3af37</code>              | Shows the colour answer card. See <a href="#">Instant answers</a> .                                          |
| Two hex codes                                   | <code>#d3af37 #0d0d0d</code>      | Shows the contrast-pair card.                                                                                |

You can combine operators, for example `type:learn "colour blindness" -quiz`.

## Filter values with spaces

Put the value in quotes after the colon: `title:"contrast ratio"`.

## A filter on its own

A filter works without any words. `type:changelog` lists changelog pages, and `tag:oklch` lists everything tagged OKLCH.

## Values for type:

**type:** must match exactly. The main values are:

| Value                | Pages                             |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>learn</b>         | Learn articles                    |
| <b>documentation</b> | Documentation guides              |
| <b>tool</b>          | Tool pages                        |
| <b>library</b>       | Library pages                     |
| <b>blog</b>          | Blog posts                        |
| <b>changelog</b>     | Changelog pages                   |
| <b>company</b>       | Company pages                     |
| <b>legal</b>         | Legal pages                       |
| <b>portfolio</b>     | Portfolios in the Portfolio Index |

The section tabs are often quicker than **type:**. See [Search this site](#).

## Web search operators

When the globe is on, the web index understands:

| Operator        | Example                         | What it does                                                                          |
|-----------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Words           | <b>color contrast</b>           | Finds pages with the words. Pages with every word are shown before pages missing one. |
| <b>"..."</b>    | <b>"design tokens"</b>          | The words together, in that order.                                                    |
| <b>-word</b>    | <b>gradient -css</b>            | Leaves out pages with the word.                                                       |
| <b>site:</b>    | <b>site:w3.org<br/>contrast</b> | Only pages on that site and its subdomains. <b>host:</b> does the same.               |
| <b>intitle:</b> | <b>intitle:palette</b>          | Only pages whose title contains the value.                                            |

The site-search operators **type:**, **tag:**, **title:**, **desc:**, **path:** and **category:** do not apply to web search, and the answer cards appear only in site search.

## Tips

- If a query with operators finds nothing, the **Worth trying** list names the operator most likely to be the cause.
- Hex codes work with or without **#**, in three-digit or six-digit form: **#abc**, **abc**, **#aabbcc** or **aabbcc**.

- A word of three or six letters made only from the letters a to f, such as **bad** or **facade**, is read as a hex code too. Put it in quotes to search for the word itself.

WEBSITE > SEARCH

## Request a crawl

How to submit pages and sitemaps in the Auric Artisan Search Console, read the crawl queue, and control what the crawler fetches with robots.txt.

The crawler finds pages by following links and by reading sitemaps. You can speed this up by submitting a page or a whole sitemap in the **Submit** section of the Search Console. Your site must be verified first; see [Set up the Search Console](#).

### Submit a page or a sitemap

1. Open **Submit** in the console's side rail. The section is headed **Crawling**.
2. In **Add a page or a sitemap**, paste an address, for example `https://example.com/sitemap.xml`.
3. As you type, a hint says what it will do: **Looks like a sitemap — every URL inside it will join the queue.** or **Queued as one page**. The hint is a guess; the console decides when it reads the address.
4. Select **Submit** or press **Enter**.

The result:

| Message                                                           | Meaning                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Read as a sitemap — 120 URLs queued.                              | The address was a sitemap, and its addresses were queued.                                |
| Read as a sitemap, but every URL in it was outside this property. | The sitemap lists addresses on a different site. Submit it under the site it belongs to. |
| Queued. It will be crawled at this host's own pace.               | The address was queued as one page.                                                      |

To queue a single address from a report, use **Ask for a crawl** in the inspection panel instead. See [Read the console reports](#).

### The queue

The first card shows how many addresses are **waiting for the next pass**, or **Nothing waiting** and **Everything known has been crawled**. When the crawler's pace is known, it adds how long the queue will take, for example **At 1,000 ms a request, about 7 minutes of crawling**.

A bar shows where the waiting addresses came from:

| Source             | Meaning              |
|--------------------|----------------------|
| from your sitemaps | Listed in a sitemap. |

| Source                   | Meaning                                       |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| you asked for            | Submitted in the console.                     |
| sitemaps to re-read      | Sitemaps due to be read again.                |
| found by following links | Found in links on pages already crawled.      |
| due a re-crawl           | Already crawled, and due to be fetched again. |

## Your sitemaps

The **Sitemaps** card lists every sitemap known for the site. Sitemaps are re-read on every pass. Each shows how the crawler knows it:

- **You added** — submitted in the console.
- **Detected** — listed on a **Sitemap:** line in your robots.txt.
- **Found while crawling** — met by following a link.

A sitemap that did not answer normally shows its HTTP status. The line below says how many addresses were queued from your sitemaps and how many sitemaps your robots.txt lists. If it lists none, add them there: that is how the crawler finds them on its own.

## What the crawler obeys

The crawler calls itself AuricBot.

- **robots.txt.** The crawler reads your robots.txt and obeys it. It follows the group for **AuricBot** if there is one, and the **\*** group otherwise. An address that robots.txt disallows is never fetched, and shows in Coverage as **Blocked by robots.txt**.
- **Crawl-delay.** The crawler waits between requests to your site so that a crawl never floods it. It uses the **Crawl-delay** in your robots.txt, between 1 and 60 seconds, or 1 second if there is none. The wait shows as **Pace** under **Your sites**.
- **noindex.** A page with a robots meta tag or an **X-Robots-Tag** header asking not to be indexed is fetched but not indexed.
- **Canonical addresses.** When two pages are near-identical, one is kept. A **rel=canonical** link tells the crawler which one you prefer.
- **Web pages only.** Only HTML pages are read and indexed. PDFs, images, feeds and downloads are not.
- **No JavaScript.** Pages that are mostly an empty shell filled in by JavaScript look empty to the crawler, and show as **Too little content**.

## Crawled is not yet searchable

Crawling and indexing are separate steps. A page that has been fetched shows as **Crawled, waiting for the next index build**. It becomes searchable when the next index build includes it.

---

## When the crawler is turned away

If your site stops the crawler, for example with a firewall or an error on every request, **Your sites** shows **The crawler is being turned away**, with the reason. Nothing on the site can be indexed until the crawler can fetch pages again. The header also changes to **Crawling stopped** with the time of the last pass.

WEBSITE > SEARCH

## Set up the Search Console

How to sign in to the Auric Artisan Search Console, add your site and prove you own it with a file, a meta tag or a DNS record.

The Search Console at <https://auricartisan.com/search/console/> shows what Auric Artisan's crawler found on a site you own, which searches put it in front of people, and, for every page that is not indexed, the reason why. It is free, for any site you own.

The console covers Auric Artisan's own web index only. What you do here changes what this index knows about your site. It has no effect on how you appear in Google, Bing or anywhere else.

---

### Before you start

- You need an Auric Artisan account. The account is needed only so that a site stays yours.
- You need to be able to change one of these for your site: a file on the web server, the home page's HTML, or the domain's DNS records.

---

### Sign in

1. Open <https://auricartisan.com/search/console/>.
2. If you are signed out, the page explains the console under **Your site, in the index**. Select **Sign in to start**, sign in, and come back.

---

### Add your site

1. Open **Your sites** in the console's side rail. With no sites yet, the page says **No properties yet. Add one below, then prove you own it**.
2. Under **Add another site**, type your domain in **Domain or URL prefix**, for example `example.com`.
3. Select **Add** or press **Enter**. The page says **Added. Prove you own it and the crawler will start**.

A domain covers every page on it, including subdomains. There is no limit on how many sites you keep.

The field also accepts a full address such as `https://example.com/docs/`. Check the name shown in the list after adding it: at present the console registers the whole domain, `example.com`.

Until you prove ownership, the site shows as pending, the other sections of the console are unavailable, and nothing is crawled.

---

## Prove you own it

The console opens a panel headed **Prove you own** your site. Choose one of three methods. Any one is enough.

| Method           | Label     | What you do                                                                                           |
|------------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| File on the site | Quickest  | Serve a text file at the address shown, containing the token. Easiest on a static site.               |
| Meta tag         | No deploy | Add the meta tag shown to the head of your home page.                                                 |
| DNS TXT record   | Strongest | Add a TXT record on your domain with the value shown. Covers every subdomain and survives a redeploy. |

Each method shows exactly what to add, with a **Copy** button:

- File: an address of the form `https://example.com/auric-site-verification-TOKEN.txt`. The file must contain the token.
- Meta tag: a line of the form `<meta name="auric-site-verification" content="TOKEN">`, to go in the head of `https://example.com/`.
- DNS: a TXT record whose value begins `auric-site-verification=`.

Then:

1. Add the file, tag or record to your site.
2. Select **Check now**. All three methods are tried, in order, whichever one you set up.
3. If one works, the page says **Verified by** that method, and the console opens.
4. If none works yet, the page says **Not verified yet — here is what each check found**. Each method is listed with ✓ or ✗, where it looked, what went wrong, what it **expected** and what it **found instead**. Fix what it names and select **Check now** again.

A new DNS record can take an hour to become visible. If the DNS check fails straight after you add the record, wait and try again.

---

## After verification

- A green line reads **Ownership proven** by your method and date. Ownership is re-checked periodically, and you are told if the proof disappears.
- Keep the file, tag or record in place. Removing a meta tag later un-verifies the site.
- Your home page is queued for crawling straight away.
- The header shows when the site was last crawled and how many addresses are queued, for example **Crawled 3 hours ago • 42 queued for the next pass**.

## The console at a glance

The side rail has these sections. All but **Your sites** and **Portfolios** need a verified site.

| Section     | What it shows                                                                                       |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overview    | Indexed pages, impressions, clicks, average position, and why pages are not indexed.                |
| Performance | Searches, pages, days, countries and devices, with impressions, clicks, click-through and position. |
| Coverage    | Every address the crawler knows, grouped by what you can do about it.                               |
| Pages       | Every address, by folder or as a list, with inspection.                                             |
| Links       | The site's rank; link reports are not collected yet.                                                |
| Submit      | Ask for a page or a sitemap to be crawled; the queue and your sitemaps.                             |
| Your sites  | Every site on your account; adding and removing sites.                                              |
| Portfolios  | Your entries in the Portfolio Index.                                                                |

With more than one site, choose which one the console shows from the switcher in the header. Every section then shows that site.

At the top, **7d**, **28d** and **90d** set the period for every dated figure. The default is **28d**.

## Next steps

- [Read the console reports](#)
- [Request a crawl](#)
- [Manage your sites](#)
- Listing a portfolio from the **Portfolios** section is covered in the Portfolio documentation: [List your portfolio](#).

WEBSITE > SEARCH

## Search the web

How to use the globe on the Auric Artisan search page to search Auric Artisan's own index of the web, with suggestions, spelling correction and paging.

The globe button beside the search field switches from the site to the web. Web search uses Auric Artisan's own crawl of the web: an independent index, very much smaller than Google's or Bing's. Pages get into it when the crawler finds them by following links, and when site owners submit them through the [Search Console](#).

## Switch the globe on

1. Select the globe button beside the search field. Its tooltip reads **Web search**. The mode label beside the status line changes from **LOCAL** to **GLOBAL**.
2. If there is already a query in the field, it runs on the web straight away.
3. To go back to site search, select the globe again.

You can also switch from the no-results screen: **Search the web instead** turns the globe on and runs the same query.

## Search

1. Type your query. In web mode, results do not update as you type. Instead, a list suggests up to eight words from the web index's own vocabulary, most common first, marked **web**.
2. Press **Enter**, or choose a suggestion, to search.
3. The status line reads **Searching the web for** your query while it works.

## Read the results

Each result shows:

- The site's icon, or the first letter of its name on a coloured tile when it has no icon.
- The page title, with your words highlighted.
- The site name and its address.
- An excerpt with your words highlighted.
- Sometimes a tag such as **missing: gradient**, when the page does not contain one of your words.

Web results always open in a new tab.

The status line says how many results the index holds, for example **365 results from the crawled index for "github"**, and how long it took. It may add:

| Status line addition                                                   | What it means                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>about</b> before the count                                          | The count is an estimate. This happens with <b>site:</b> and <b>intitle:</b> filters.                                                       |
| <b>answered without</b> a word, <b>exact matches first</b>             | No page had every word, so the search was relaxed. Pages with all your words, if any, come first.                                           |
| <b>showing results for</b> a word; <b>search instead for</b> your word | Your query found nothing, so a corrected spelling was used. Select <b>search instead for</b> to see the results for your original spelling. |

---

## More results

Web results come 20 at a time. Under the list, **More results** shows how many are left, for example **More results 345 left**. Select it to add the next 20. The button disappears when there is nothing more.

---

## Operators

Web search understands phrases in quotes, **-word** exclusions, **site:** (or **host:**) and **intitle:**. See [Query syntax](#).

---

## When the index has nothing

If the crawled index has no results for your query, the page searches the web live instead. This takes longer. The status line then reads, for example, **12 global results from 4 sources, 15 crawled pages**. If that finds nothing too, it reads **No global results for** your query. If it fails, it reads **Global search failed for** your query, with the reason.

---

## What web mode does not do

The section tabs, sorting, answer cards and ranking panel belong to site search. They do not apply to web results.

---

## Your privacy in web mode

Web queries are sent to Auric Artisan's search service, unlike site search. When you open a web result, the page tells Auric Artisan the query, which result you chose and its position in the list. This helps ranking, and it gives site owners their click counts in the Search Console. Site icons are fetched through Auric Artisan, so other services are not told which sites appear in your results. See [Privacy](#).

WEBSITE > SEARCH

## Search this site

How site search works on the Auric Artisan search page — typing, suggestions, results, section tabs, sorting, paging, corrections and recent searches.

Site search is the default mode of the search page. The mode label beside the status line reads **LOCAL**.

---

## Type a query

- Type at least two characters. Results update as you type, after a short pause.
- Words shorter than two letters and very common words such as "the", "and" or "with" are ignored.

- A word does not have to be complete: **grad** finds pages about gradients.
- Small typing mistakes are tolerated. A word of three to five letters may be one letter out; a longer word may be two out. This applies only when the word as typed matches nothing.
- Related words also count, at reduced weight, when your query has four words or fewer. For example, **palette** also finds pages that say "swatch" or "scheme", and **colour** also finds "color". These related words appear dashed in the line under the field.

---

## Suggestions

While you type, a list opens under the field with up to eight suggestions:

- **Pages** whose title or address contains what you typed. Choose one to open that page.
- **Tags**, shown with a **#**, for example **#ok1ch**. Choose one to search for pages with that tag.

Close the list with **Escape**, or by clicking elsewhere on the page.

---

## Read the results

The status line above the list says how many results there are and how long the search took, for example **About 24 results (3 ms)**.

Each result shows:

- A coloured dot and the kind of page: **Tool**, **Learn**, **Docs**, **Blog**, **Portfolio** or **Page**.
- The page's address on the site.
- The title, with the words you searched for highlighted.
- A short excerpt or description.

Results open in the same tab, except a portfolio kept on another website, which opens in a new tab.

---

## Narrow by section

The tabs under the field filter the results you already have:

| Tab   | What it contains                     |
|-------|--------------------------------------|
| All   | Every result.                        |
| Tools | Tool pages and the Collections page. |
| Learn | Learn articles.                      |
| Docs  | Documentation and changelog pages.   |
| Blog  | Blog posts.                          |

| Tab        | What it contains                                                                                                              |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Portfolios | Portfolios in the Portfolio Index, both builder portfolios and ones kept on other sites, and the Portfolio Index page itself. |
| Pages      | Everything else: the colour libraries, company, legal, download and other pages.                                              |

Each tab shows its count. A tab with no results for the current query is greyed out.

---

## Sort

Open **Tools** at the end of the tab row. Under **Sort by**:

- **Relevance** — the default.
- **Newest** — pages with a date in their address come first, newest first. Pages without a date go last.
- **A-Z** — by title.

Sorting appears only when there are at least two results. It goes back to **Relevance** when you clear the search.

---

## Paging

The first 20 results show at once. As you scroll near the bottom, more are added 12 at a time. When every result is on screen, a line says so, for example **All 38 shown**. The page lists up to 100 results for a query.

---

## When a word is misspelt

If a correction is likely, the status line adds **did you mean** followed by the corrected query. Select it to search for that instead. The correction is not offered when the results for your spelling are already strong.

---

## When nothing matches

The page shows **Nothing matched that** and **No page on this site matches** your query. Below it:

- **Did you mean**, when a correction exists.
- **Search the web instead**, which switches to the globe and runs the same query. See [Search the web](#).
- **Worth trying** — advice worked out from your query. For example, it suggests dropping a filter, removing an exclusion, unquoting a phrase or using fewer words.
- **Or start from a section** — links to **Tools**, **Learn**, **Documentation** and **Palettes**.

---

## Recent searches

A search counts as recent when you press **Enter** or open a result. The six most recent appear on the start screen next to **Recent**. Select one to run it again, or select **Clear** to empty the list. The same list is used by Spotlight, the quick search you open with **Ctrl + K**.

---

## Share or bookmark a search

The page address follows your search. A query adds **?q=** and a section tab adds **&scope=**, for example **<https://auricartisan.com/search/?q=contrast&scope=learn>**. Open that address and the same search runs.

---

## Results you open rise over time

When you open a result, this browser remembers it. Pages you choose often are nudged up in your future results. This stays in your browser; see [Privacy](#).

---

## Related

- [Query syntax](#)
- [Understand the ranking](#)
- [Shortcuts](#)

WEBSITE > SEARCH

## Understand the ranking

How site search orders results, the "Why it ranks here" panel, the field weights and the option to show a score on every result.

Site search orders results by relevance, and it shows its working. You can see why any result sits where it does, and switch on a score for every row.

---

## How results are scored

The page uses a ranking method called BM25F. Each page is split into six fields, and a match in a heavier field counts for more:

| Field       | Weight |
|-------------|--------|
| Title       | ×6     |
| Tags        | ×4     |
| Description | ×3     |

| Field    | Weight |
|----------|--------|
| Category | ×2     |
| URL      | ×1.5   |
| Content  | ×1     |

On top of that:

- Rare words count for more than common ones.
- Pages that contain more of your words, and have them close together, rank higher.
- Partial words (such as **grad** for "gradient") and corrected typos count, but less than exact words.
- Related words, shown dashed under the field, count at half weight.
- Pages you have opened from search before are nudged up, in this browser only.

The same table is printed on the page: open **Tools** at the end of the tab row and look under **Ranking**. It also shows the two tuning values, **k1 / b**, as **1.2 / 0.4**.

---

## Why it ranks here

Hover a result, or highlight it with the arrow keys, and a panel opens above the list. It shows:

- The kind of page and its title, address and description.
- **Why it ranks here** — the **BM25F score**, then each field that matched, with its weight and how many times your words appear in it.
- **Matched on** — the words that matched, with related words shown dashed.
- **Open the page**.

When a query produces an answer card, the card and the panel share the space above the list.

---

## Show the score on every result

Open **Tools** and tick **Show the score on every result**. Each result then shows:

- A bar for its score relative to the top result.
- The score as a number.
- Up to three fields it matched in, with the count for each. Heavier fields are emphasised.

This setting is remembered in this browser. Untick it to hide the scores again.

---

## Why a result you expected is missing

- The page may use a different word. Try a synonym, or a shorter form of the word.
- An operator may be ruling it out. The **Worth trying** list on the no-results screen names it.

- The page may be newer than the index in your browser. See [Troubleshooting](#).

WEBSITE > SEARCH

# Search reference

Every control, operator, status line, message and limit on the Auric Artisan search page and in the Search Console.

## Search page controls

| Control                               | What it does                                                                                          | Values or range                                         | Default          |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Search field                          | Takes your query. Results start at two characters.                                                    | Any text                                                | Empty            |
| Clear button                          | Empties the field and returns to the start screen. Appears once you type.                             | —                                                       | Hidden           |
| Globe button ( <b>Web search</b> )    | Switches between site search and web search.                                                          | On, off                                                 | Off              |
| Mode label                            | Shows which index you are searching.                                                                  | <b>LOCAL, GLOBAL</b>                                    | <b>LOCAL</b>     |
| Suggestions list                      | Pages and tags that match what you typed (site search), or words from the web index (web search).     | Up to 8                                                 | —                |
| Section tabs                          | Filter site-search results by kind of page, with a count on each.                                     | <b>All, Tools, Learn, Docs, Blog, Portfolios, Pages</b> | <b>All</b>       |
| <b>Tools</b> menu                     | Opens sorting and ranking options.                                                                    | —                                                       | Closed           |
| <b>Sort by</b>                        | Orders site-search results. Shown with two or more results.                                           | <b>Relevance, Newest, A–Z</b>                           | <b>Relevance</b> |
| <b>Ranking</b>                        | Shows the field weights and tuning values.                                                            | —                                                       | —                |
| <b>Show the score on every result</b> | Adds a score bar, number and matched fields to each result. Remembered in this browser.               | On, off                                                 | Off              |
| Query chips                           | Show how the query was read: filters, colours, phrases, words, exclusions and related words (dashed). | —                                                       | —                |
| <b>did you mean</b>                   | Runs the corrected query.                                                                             | —                                                       | —                |
| <b>More results</b>                   | Loads the next 20 web results, with how many are left.                                                | —                                                       | —                |
| <b>Search the web instead</b>         | On the no-results screen: turns the globe on and runs the query.                                      | —                                                       | —                |
| <b>Recent</b> chips                   | Run a recent search again.                                                                            | Up to 6                                                 | —                |
| <b>Clear</b> (recent)                 | Empties the recent searches list.                                                                     | —                                                       | —                |

## Section tabs

| Tab        | Contents                                        | Result label |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Tools      | Tool pages and Collections                      | Tool         |
| Learn      | Learn articles                                  | Learn        |
| Docs       | Documentation and changelog                     | Docs         |
| Blog       | Blog posts                                      | Blog         |
| Portfolios | Portfolio Index entries and the index page      | Portfolio    |
| Pages      | Everything else, including the colour libraries | Page         |

## Field weights

| Field       | Weight    |
|-------------|-----------|
| Title       | ×6        |
| Tags        | ×4        |
| Description | ×3        |
| Category    | ×2        |
| URL         | ×1.5      |
| Content     | ×1        |
| k1 / b      | 1.2 / 0.4 |

## Operators

| Operator             | Site search | Web search |
|----------------------|-------------|------------|
| "a phrase"           | Yes         | Yes        |
| -word                | Yes         | Yes        |
| type:                | Yes         | No         |
| tag:                 | Yes         | No         |
| title:               | Yes         | No         |
| desc: , description: | Yes         | No         |
| path:                | Yes         | No         |
| category:            | Yes         | No         |

| Operator                                | Site search | Web search |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------|------------|
| <code>site:</code> , <code>host:</code> | No          | Yes        |
| <code>intitle:</code>                   | No          | Yes        |
| Hex code or two hex codes               | Answer card | No         |

Details and examples: [Query syntax](#).

## Start screen

| Element                       | What it does                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Privacy line                  | <b>Indexed on this device — nothing you type leaves the browser</b>                                                 |
| <b>Paste a hex</b> card       | Runs the query <code>#D3AF37</code> .                                                                               |
| <b>Give it two</b> card       | Runs the query <code>#D3AF37 #0D0D0D</code> .                                                                       |
| <b>Narrow by section</b> card | Runs <code>type:learn contrast</code> and shows its first two results and count.                                    |
| Section ribbon                | The largest sections with their page counts, each linking to its section; and the total <b>pages in the index</b> . |
| <b>More ways to ask</b>       | Puts <code>type:learn</code> , <code>"a phrase"</code> , <code>-word</code> or <code>tag:ok1ch</code> in the field. |
| <b>Put your site in it</b>    | Opens the Search Console.                                                                                           |

## Answer cards

| Card                 | Appears when                                                                                                                                                                   | Buttons                                                |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Colour</b>        | The query holds one hex code.                                                                                                                                                  | <b>Check it against a background, Palettes with it</b> |
| <b>Contrast pair</b> | The query holds two or more hex codes.                                                                                                                                         | <b>Open the checker, Swap them</b>                     |
| <b>Tool</b>          | The whole query is <code>contrast</code> , <code>contrast checker</code> , <code>palette</code> , <code>gradient</code> , <code>image picker</code> or <code>analyzer</code> . | <b>Open the tool</b>                                   |

Grades and thresholds: [Instant answers](#).

## Status lines

| Status line                                  | When                           |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Index ready — N items indexed in N ms</b> | The page has loaded its index. |

| Status line                                              | When                                                                |
|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Search index is empty. Try refreshing the page.          | The index did not load.                                             |
| About N results (N ms)                                   | Site-search results. Adds <b>in</b> a section when a tab is chosen. |
| No results for your query                                | Nothing matched in site search.                                     |
| All N shown                                              | Every site-search result is on screen.                              |
| Searching the web for your query                         | Web search is running.                                              |
| N results from the crawled index for your query          | Web results from the index.                                         |
| about N results                                          | The web count is an estimate.                                       |
| answered without a word, exact matches first             | The web search was relaxed.                                         |
| showing results for a word; search instead for your word | The web search corrected your spelling.                             |
| N global results from N sources                          | Live web results, used when the index had none.                     |
| No global results for your query                         | The live web search found nothing.                                  |
| Global search failed for your query                      | The live web search failed.                                         |

## Page address parameters

| Parameter | What it does                                                                                                                    | Example                      |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| q         | Runs a site search for the value.                                                                                               | /search/?q=ok1ch             |
| scope     | Opens a section tab: <b>all</b> , <b>tools</b> , <b>learn</b> , <b>docs</b> , <b>blog</b> , <b>portfolios</b> or <b>pages</b> . | /search/?q=ok1ch&scope=learn |

## Limits

| Item                       | Limit                              |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Shortest query             | 2 characters                       |
| Site-search results listed | Up to 100                          |
| First site-search page     | 20 results, then 12 more at a time |
| Web results per page       | 20                                 |
| Suggestions                | Up to 8                            |
| Recent searches            | 6                                  |

## Search Console: layout

| Control       | What it does                                                                                   | Values                                                                               | Default                                    |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Site switcher | Chooses the site every section shows.<br>Appears with two or more sites.                       | Your sites                                                                           | The site needing attention, else the first |
| Period        | Sets the period for every dated figure.                                                        | <b>7d, 28d, 90d</b>                                                                  | <b>28d</b>                                 |
| Header line   | Last crawl and queue, for example<br><b>Crawled 3 hours ago • 42 queued for the next pass.</b> | —                                                                                    | —                                          |
| Side rail     | Opens a section. Arrow keys, <b>Home</b> and <b>End</b> move between sections.                 | <b>Overview, Performance, Coverage, Pages, Links, Submit, Your sites, Portfolios</b> | <b>Overview</b>                            |

## Search Console: verification

| Method                  | Label     | What to add                                                                                    | Notes                                               |
|-------------------------|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>File on the site</b> | Quickest  | A text file at <code>/auric-site-verification-TOKEN.txt</code> containing the token            | Easiest on a static site.                           |
| <b>Meta tag</b>         | No deploy | <code>&lt;meta name="auric-site-verification" content="TOKEN"&gt;</code> in the home page head | Removing it later un-verifies the site.             |
| <b>DNS TXT record</b>   | Strongest | A TXT record with the value shown                                                              | Covers every subdomain; can take an hour to appear. |

**Check now** tries all three. The report for each shows ✓ or ✗, where it looked, the detail, **expected** and **found instead**.

## Search Console: Performance

| Control or figure                                        | Meaning                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Impressions</b>                                       | Times your site appeared in a web-search result.                                             |
| <b>Clicks</b>                                            | Times someone opened it.                                                                     |
| <b>Click-through, CTR</b>                                | Clicks divided by impressions.                                                               |
| <b>Average position, Position</b>                        | Where it appeared in the list; lower is better.                                              |
| <b>By search, By page, By day, By country, By device</b> | How the table is grouped. Default <b>By search</b> .                                         |
| Change badges                                            | Percentage change against the previous period, or <b>no change</b> .                         |
| Name or topic bar                                        | Impressions from searches for your name against searches for a topic. <b>By search</b> only. |

## Search Console: Coverage totals

| Total         | Meaning                                                   |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| On its way    | Fetches and keeps. Searchable after the next index build. |
| Needs you     | Only you can change these.                                |
| Nothing to do | Real, counted, and working as intended.                   |

## Coverage reasons

| Label                                     | Yours to fix | Meaning                                             | What to do                                             |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Indexed                                   | —            | Fetches, keeps and searchable.                      | Nothing.                                               |
| Discovered, not yet crawled               | No           | Known and queued; crawling is paced per site.       | Nothing, or submit it to move it up.                   |
| Crawled, waiting for the next index build | No           | Fetches and keeps; searchable after the next build. | Nothing.                                               |
| Blocked by robots.txt                     | Yes          | Your robots.txt tells crawlers not to fetch it.     | Allow the path in robots.txt.                          |
| Excluded by noindex                       | Yes          | The page asks not to be indexed.                    | Remove the noindex tag or header.                      |
| Too little content                        | Yes          | Almost no text once navigation is stripped.         | Serve real text; the crawler does not run JavaScript.  |
| Not found                                 | Yes          | The server answered 404, but something links to it. | Restore, redirect or remove the links.                 |
| Timed out                                 | Yes          | The server did not answer in time.                  | Speed up the page; it is retried.                      |
| Could not be fetched                      | Yes          | The request failed. It is retried.                  | Check the page is reachable from outside your network. |
| Duplicate of another page                 | No           | Near-identical to an indexed page.                  | Nothing, or set <code>rel=canonical</code> .           |
| Redirected                                | No           | Forwards elsewhere; the destination is indexed.     | Nothing, unless the destination is wrong.              |
| A sitemap, read for its links             | No           | A sitemap; its addresses were queued.               | Nothing.                                               |
| Not a web page                            | No           | Not HTML, such as a PDF or image.                   | Nothing, unless you expected a page.                   |

## Search Console: Pages

| Control              | What it does                                                          | Default           |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Find a path          | Filters addresses as you type.                                        | Empty             |
| State chips          | <b>Everything, Indexed, Waiting, Excluded, Errored</b> , with counts. | <b>Everything</b> |
| By folder, Flat list | Groups addresses by folder, or lists them.                            | <b>By folder</b>  |
| Inspect              | Opens the inspection panel for one address.                           | —                 |

## Search Console: inspection

| Field or button               | Meaning                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Verdict                       | The state in words, with <b>To fix:</b> or <b>Note:</b> .                                                   |
| Status                        | The HTTP status at the last crawl.                                                                          |
| Canonical                     | The canonical address the page gave.                                                                        |
| First seen, Last indexed      | When the crawler first met it, and when it last entered the index.                                          |
| Indexed title                 | The title held in the index.                                                                                |
| Static rank                   | The page's weight, out of 255.                                                                              |
| In the queue, Last error      | Where a queued address came from, its priority and attempts, and its last error.                            |
| Fetch the page now, Test live | Fetch the live page and show <b>Outcome, Redirects to, Canonical, Robots meta</b> and <b>X-Robots-Tag</b> . |
| Still noindex                 | The live page still asks not to be indexed.                                                                 |
| Title has changed             | The live title differs from the indexed one.                                                                |
| Searches it appears for       | Searches, impressions and position for this address.                                                        |
| Ask for a crawl               | Queues the address.                                                                                         |

## Search Console: Submit

| Item                    | Meaning                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Add a page or a sitemap | The address to crawl. <b>Submit</b> or <b>Enter</b> sends it.                                           |
| Queue sources           | <b>from your sitemaps, you asked for, sitemaps to re-read, found by following links, due a re-crawl</b> |
| Sitemap tags            | <b>You added, Detected, Found while crawling</b>                                                        |

## Search Console: messages

| Message                                                                                                            | Meaning                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Sign in to use the Search Console.                                                                                 | You are signed out.                                       |
| Type a domain or a URL prefix first.                                                                               | <b>Add</b> was selected with an empty field.              |
| You have already added that property.                                                                              | The site is already on your account.                      |
| A property is a domain like <code>example.com</code> or a URL prefix like <code>https://example.com/docs/</code> . | The value was not a valid domain.                         |
| Verify a property first.                                                                                           | The section needs a verified site.                        |
| Which URL?                                                                                                         | <b>Submit</b> was selected with an empty field.           |
| The search service did not answer.                                                                                 | The console could not reach its service. Try again later. |

WEBSITE > SEARCH

## Troubleshooting

Symptoms, causes and fixes for problems with the Auric Artisan search page, web search and the Search Console.

### Search page

#### Nothing happens when I type

**Why:** Search starts at two characters, and the page may still be loading its index. While it loads, the page shows **Building search index...**

**What to do:** Type at least two characters and wait for **Index ready**. If the status line says **Search index is empty. Try refreshing the page.**, reload the page.

#### A page I know exists does not appear

**Why:** The page may use different words, an operator may be ruling it out, or the page may be newer than the index your browser has.

**What to do:**

- Try a shorter or different word. The **Worth trying** list on the no-results screen suggests changes based on your query.
- Remove filters, exclusions and quotes one at a time.
- Check the section tab: select **All**.
- Reload the page to fetch the latest index.

## A section tab is greyed out

**Why:** That section has no results for the current query.

**What to do:** Select **All**, or change the query.

## Sorting by Newest looks out of order

**Why:** **Newest** uses the date in a page's address. Pages without a date, which are most pages, go to the end in no particular date order.

**What to do:** Use **Newest** for dated pages such as blog posts and changelog entries, together with the **Blog** or **Docs** tab.

## A word I typed shows a colour card

**Why:** A word of three or six letters made only from a to f, such as **bad**, **add** or **facade**, is read as a hex code.

**What to do:** Put the word in quotes: **"facade"**.

## The tool card does not appear

**Why:** The tool card appears only when the whole query is a tool's name, with no other words, filters, phrases or exclusions.

**What to do:** Search for the name alone, for example **contrast**.

## Palettes with it opens the Palette Library without my colour

**Why:** The library opens at its usual view.

**What to do:** Type the hex code into the Palette Library's search field.

## My recent searches are missing

**Why:** Recent searches are saved in this browser. A private window, another browser, or clearing site data starts an empty list. Half-typed queries are not saved; a search is saved when you press **Enter** or open a result.

**What to do:** Search again. The list refills as you search.

---

## Web search

### Results do not update as I type

**Why:** In web mode, typing shows word suggestions only.

**What to do:** Press **Enter** or choose a suggestion.

## "Global search failed"

**Why:** The index had nothing for the query, and the live web search that followed did not complete.

**What to do:** Try again in a moment, or change the query.

## The results are about a different word

**Why:** Your query found nothing, so the search corrected the spelling. The status line says **showing results for** the corrected word.

**What to do:** Select **search instead for** your word to see its results, even if there are none.

## The count starts with "about"

**Why:** With **site:** or **intitle:**, the total can only be estimated.

**What to do:** Nothing; the results themselves are exact matches.

## A site I expected is not in the web results

**Why:** The web index is Auric Artisan's own crawl, far smaller than the large search engines. The site may not have been found yet.

**What to do:** If it is your site, add it in the [Search Console](#) and submit its sitemap.

---

## Search Console

### The console shows a sign-in page

**Why:** The console needs an Auric Artisan account.

**What to do:** Select **Sign in to start**, sign in, and return to <https://auricartisan.com/search/console/>.

### Sections are greyed out

**Why:** The open site is not verified yet. Only **Your sites** and **Portfolios** work until it is.

**What to do:** Complete the **Prove you own** panel. See [Set up the Search Console](#).

### Verification fails

**Why:** The console could not find the file, tag or record it expected.

**What to do:** Read the report under **Not verified yet**. It shows where each check looked, what it **expected** and what it **found instead**. Common causes:

- The file is at a different address, or does not contain the token.
- The meta tag is not on the home page, or not in its head.
- The DNS record has not appeared yet. It can take an hour.
- The site redirects the home page or the file somewhere else.

## **I added a URL prefix but the list shows the whole domain**

**Why:** At present the console registers the domain of any address you type.

**What to do:** Nothing is lost: the property covers the whole domain, including the section you meant. Prove ownership of the domain.

## **"Read as a sitemap, but every URL in it was outside this property."**

**Why:** The sitemap lists addresses on a different domain from the open site.

**What to do:** Open the right site in the console, or add that domain as a site of its own.

## **Pages stay "Crawled, waiting for the next index build"**

**Why:** Crawling and indexing are separate steps. A crawled page becomes searchable when the next index build includes it.

**What to do:** Wait. Nothing you do on your site speeds this up.

## **Many pages show "Too little content"**

**Why:** The crawler does not run JavaScript. Pages that build their text with JavaScript look empty to it.

**What to do:** Serve the main text in the HTML itself, for example with server-side or static rendering.

## **The console says the crawler is being turned away**

**Why:** Your site is refusing the crawler's requests, for example with a firewall rule or bot protection.

**What to do:** Allow requests from the AuricBot crawler, then submit a page to test. Check **Your sites** and **Coverage** for the result.

## **Performance shows no impressions**

**Why:** Impressions count only appearances in Auric Artisan's own web search, which is much smaller than the big search engines. A new site may have none.

**What to do:** Make sure your pages are indexed. The message **No impressions recorded yet.** changes once your site first appears in a result.

## **The Links section is empty**

**Why:** Link reports are not collected yet.

**What to do:** Use **Coverage** and **Pages** for broken links (**Not found**), and the rank shown on **Links** for the site's weight.

**"The search service did not answer."**

**Why:** The console could not reach its service.

**What to do:** Check your connection and try again later.

WEBSITE > SEARCH

## Search FAQ

Short answers to common questions about the Auric Artisan search page, web search and the Search Console.

---

### Does the site search send what I type anywhere?

No. Site search runs in your browser against an index the page downloads once. The start screen says so: **Indexed on this device — nothing you type leaves the browser**. Web search is different; see below.

---

### Does web search send my query?

Yes. With the globe on, your query goes to Auric Artisan's search service. When you open a web result, the query, the result and its position are reported too. See [Privacy](#).

---

### Is web search the same as Google?

No. It is Auric Artisan's own independent crawl of the web, much smaller than Google's or Bing's.

---

### Do I need an account to search?

No. Only the Search Console needs an account.

---

### Can I link to a search?

Yes. Copy the page address after searching. It includes `?q=` and, for a section tab, `&scope=`.

---

### Why does a hex code show a card instead of results?

A colour is usually the answer to a colour query. The card shows the colour and its contrast. The results for the hex code, if any, follow below it.

---

## Which colour comes first in a pair?

The text colour first, then the background: `#d3af37 #0d0d0d` is gold text on near-black. The ratio is the same either way; the sample text changes. **Swap them** reverses the pair.

---

## Why does #777777 on white fail AA?

Its ratio is 4.48:1, just under the 4.5:1 that AA needs for body text. The card uses the exact ratio, not a rounded one.

---

## Why did a page about swatches appear when I searched for palettes?

Related words count at reduced weight. The line under the field shows them dashed. See [Understand the ranking](#).

---

## Is the Search Console free?

Yes, for any site you own.

---

## Does the Search Console affect my Google ranking?

No. It changes only what Auric Artisan's own index knows about your site.

---

## How long until a submitted page is searchable?

A page asked for from the inspection panel is crawled within a day. After crawling it waits for the next index build before it becomes searchable.

---

## How do I stop the crawler?

Disallow it in your robots.txt, in a group for `AuricBot` or for all crawlers (`*`). See [Request a crawl](#).

---

## If I remove my site from the console, does it leave the index?

No. Its pages stay in the index. Removing it takes the site off your console and deletes its search history.

---

## How many sites can I add?

There is no limit.

---

## Can I list my portfolio from the console?

Yes, in the **Portfolios** section. See [List your portfolio](#).

[WEBSITE](#) > [SEARCH](#)

# Search: other material

Supporting material for the Auric Artisan search page and the Search Console.

| File                                | What it covers                                                     |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Glossary</a>            | Index, impression, property, canonical and other terms.            |
| <a href="#">Shortcuts</a>           | Keys on the search page and in the Search Console.                 |
| <a href="#">Limits and accuracy</a> | What each index covers, how exact the numbers are, and the limits. |
| <a href="#">Related</a>             | Spotlight, tools and pages that work with search.                  |
| <a href="#">Privacy</a>             | What stays in your browser, what is sent, and how to clear it.     |

Back to the [Search overview](#).

[WEBSITE](#) > [SEARCH](#)

# Search shortcuts

Keyboard shortcuts on the Auric Artisan search page and in the Search Console.

## Getting to search

| Keys or action                                     | What it does                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Ctrl + K</b>                                    | Opens Spotlight from any page. Choose <b>View all results for</b> your query to open the search page. |
| Right-click selected text, <b>Search this site</b> | Searches the site for the selected text in a new tab.                                                 |

## In the search field

| Keys              | What it does                                                                                                   |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>↓ / ↑</b>      | Moves through the suggestions, or through the results when no suggestions are open. Wraps round at the ends.   |
| <b>Home / End</b> | Jumps to the first or last suggestion or result, once one is highlighted. Otherwise they move the text cursor. |
| <b>Enter</b>      | Opens the highlighted suggestion or result. With nothing highlighted, runs the search and saves it as recent.  |
| <b>Escape</b>     | Closes the suggestions. Pressed again, clears the query.                                                       |

## Outside the search field

| Keys  | What it does                                                      |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ↓ / ↑ | Selects the next or previous result and shows why it ranks there. |
| Enter | Opens the selected result.                                        |
| End   | Goes to the bottom of the page once every result is shown.        |

These keys do nothing while you are typing in another field, or when **Ctrl**, **Alt** or a command key is held.

## Search Console

| Keys            | What it does                                                                                              |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ↓ / → and ↑ / ← | Move between sections in the side rail when it has focus.                                                 |
| Home / End      | The first or last section in the side rail.                                                               |
| Enter           | Adds the site in <b>Domain or URL prefix</b> , or submits the address in <b>Add a page or a sitemap</b> . |
| Escape          | Closes the inspection panel or the remove dialog.                                                         |

WEBSITE > SEARCH

## Search glossary

Terms used on the Auric Artisan search page and in the Search Console.

| Term                | Meaning                                                                                                  |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AuricBot            | The name Auric Artisan's crawler uses when it fetches pages.                                             |
| BM25F               | The ranking method site search uses: it scores word matches, weighting each field of a page differently. |
| Canonical address   | The address a page names as its preferred version, with a <b>rel=canonical</b> link.                     |
| Click               | In the Search Console, a searcher opening your page from a web-search result.                            |
| Click-through (CTR) | Clicks divided by impressions.                                                                           |
| Coverage            | Which of a site's addresses are in the index, and why the others are not.                                |
| Crawl               | Fetching a page so it can be indexed.                                                                    |
| Crawled index       | Auric Artisan's own index of the web, searched with the globe.                                           |
| Crawl-delay         | A robots.txt line asking crawlers to wait between requests.                                              |
| Exclusion           | A <b>-word</b> in a query, which leaves out pages containing the word.                                   |
| Field filter        | An operator such as <b>type:</b> or <b>tag:</b> that narrows results by one field.                       |

| Term               | Meaning                                                                                       |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Impression         | In the Search Console, one appearance of your page in a web-search result.                    |
| Index              | The collection of pages a search looks through.                                               |
| Index build        | The step that makes crawled pages searchable.                                                 |
| Inspection         | The Search Console panel that explains one address.                                           |
| LOCAL, GLOBAL      | The mode label: site search or web search.                                                    |
| noindex            | A robots meta tag or header asking search engines not to index a page.                        |
| Pace               | How long the crawler waits between requests to one site.                                      |
| Phrase             | Words in quotes, which must appear together and in order.                                     |
| Position           | Where a result appeared in the list; 1 is the top.                                            |
| Property           | A site you have added to the Search Console.                                                  |
| Rank (static rank) | A page's or site's weight from links between sites, out of 255.                               |
| Related word       | A word linked to yours, such as swatch for palette, matched at reduced weight.                |
| robots.txt         | A file at the root of a site that tells crawlers what they may fetch.                         |
| Section tab        | A filter on the search page for one kind of page, such as <b>Learn</b> .                      |
| Sitemap            | A file listing a site's addresses for crawlers.                                               |
| Verification       | Proving to the Search Console that you own a site.                                            |
| WCAG 2.1           | The Web Content Accessibility Guidelines version whose contrast formula the answer cards use. |

## WEBSITE > SEARCH

# Limits and accuracy

What each Auric Artisan search index covers, how exact the answers and console figures are, and the limits that apply.

## Site search

- **What is covered.** The public pages of Auric Artisan: tools, Learn articles, documentation, blog, changelog, company, legal and similar pages, plus portfolios listed in the Portfolio Index. The start screen shows the current total as **pages in the index**.
- **What is not covered.** The contents of the libraries themselves. Individual colours, palettes, gradients and scales are not pages in the index; search inside each library for those.
- **Freshness.** Your browser downloads the index when you open the page. A page published after that appears when you reload.
- **Result cap.** Up to 100 results are listed for a query.

- **Words.** Words under two letters and very common words are ignored. Typo tolerance applies only to words of three letters or more that match nothing as typed.
  - **Newest.** Sorting by date uses a date in the page's address; most pages have none.
- 

## Answer cards

- Contrast ratios use the WCAG 2.1 relative luminance formula on sRGB colours. They match the standard reference values: 21:1 for white on black, and 4.54:1 for **#767676** on white.
  - Grades are decided on the exact ratio. The ratio shown is rounded to two decimals, so a pair shown as 4.50:1 can still be just under the threshold.
  - OKLCH values are converted from sRGB and rounded: lightness to one decimal of a percent, chroma to three decimals, hue to one decimal of a degree.
  - The cards check contrast only. They do not judge font size, weight or the rest of WCAG. For a full check, use the Contrast Checker or the URL Analyzer.
- 

## Web search

- The web index is Auric Artisan's own crawl, very much smaller than Google's or Bing's.
  - The crawler reads HTML only and does not run JavaScript.
  - Counts marked **about** are estimates.
  - When the index has nothing, the live fallback searches a limited number of pages and takes longer.
- 

## Search Console

- Impressions, clicks and positions come only from Auric Artisan's own web search.
  - The period can be 7, 28 or 90 days, compared with the same length of time before it.
  - **Pages** shows the most recently crawled addresses on a large site, and says so.
  - **Links** reports are not collected yet; only the site's rank is shown.
  - Crawl speed per site follows its **Crawl-delay**, between 1 and 60 seconds, with 1 second when none is set.
  - There is no limit on the number of sites per account.
- 

## Sponsored units

The search page may show units clearly labelled **Sponsored**. They are not search results and are not ranked with them.

WEBSITE > SEARCH

## Privacy

What the Auric Artisan search page and Search Console keep in your browser, what they send, and how to clear it.

---

## Site search

Site search runs on your device. The page downloads the site's index and the list of portfolios once, and matches your queries in the browser. What you type in site search is not sent anywhere.

These are saved in this browser only:

| What                                              | Why                                                 | How to clear                                |
|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Your six most recent searches                     | To offer them on the start screen and in Spotlight. | Select <b>Clear</b> next to <b>Recent</b> . |
| Which results you have opened                     | To nudge those pages up in your future results.     | Clear this site's data in your browser.     |
| The <b>Show the score on every result</b> setting | To remember your choice.                            | Untick the setting, or clear site data.     |

A private window starts with none of these and forgets them when you close it.

---

## Web search

With the globe on, the page sends to Auric Artisan's search service:

- Your query, and the words you type, for suggestions.
- When you open a web result: the query, which result you chose and its position in the list.

Clicks are used to improve ranking and to give site owners their click counts in the Search Console. Site icons in the results are fetched through Auric Artisan, so other services are not told which sites appear in your results. Web results open other websites in a new tab; those sites have their own privacy terms.

---

## The Search Console

- The console needs an Auric Artisan account, so that the sites you add stay yours.
  - Your sites, their verification and their reports are tied to your account.
  - Impressions, clicks, positions, countries and devices are counts of searches on Auric Artisan's web search. They are not shown to you with any searcher's identity.
  - Removing a site from your console deletes its search history for good. The site's pages stay in the index, because they were crawled from the open web. To keep pages out of the index, use robots.txt or noindex on the site itself.
- 

## Sponsored units

The search page can show clearly labelled **Sponsored** units. For how advertising works on Auric Artisan and what it does and does not track, see [Advertise](#). Paid subscribers browse without ads.

---

## More

- [Company and legal](#) — the privacy policy and cookie settings for the whole site.

WEBSITE > SEARCH

## Related

Site features, tools and pages that work with the Auric Artisan search page and the Search Console.

---

### Other ways to find things

- [Site features](#) — Spotlight ( **Ctrl** + **K** ), the site menu and the right-click menu, which all lead into search.
  - [Library](#) — the Learn articles, documentation, blog and changelog that site search covers.
  - [Collections](#) — every tool, browsable and filterable.
- 

### Where the answer cards lead

- [Contrast Checker](#) — **Check it against a background** and **Open the checker**.
  - [Palette Library](#) — **Palettes with it**.
  - [URL Analyzer](#) — a full contrast and accessibility check of a web page.
- 

### Portfolios

- [Portfolio Builder and Portfolio Index](#) — portfolios appear in site search under **Portfolios**, and the Search Console's **Portfolios** section lists yours.
- 

### Account

- [Account and billing](#) — the account the Search Console needs.